

How we Test



It looks good and the technology is glitzy, but does it do the job?

The Digital Media Test & Research Centre (DMTRC) conducts a series of elaborate tests to evaluate the merit of each hardware and software product. To ensure that our readers have all the information they need to make an informed buying decision, engineers at DMTRC evaluate and review the latest hardware, software and technology services in accordance with the most up-to-date evaluation processes and methodologies used around the world.



The Awards

Digit awards outstanding products by selecting a Best Performance and Best Value winner in each comparison test. The winner of the Best Performance Award will be the product that scored the highest in the performance segment of our tests.

This award represents the best performing product in our tests and doesn't factor in any other parameter such as value for money, features, support, etc. The winner of the Best Value Award will be the product that scores the highest in our value for money parameter which is derived

taking into account the ratio of a product's performance and features to its price. The product winning this award offers good performance at a great price.



In Bazaar

The second part of the rating system is used to evaluate individual hardware and software products in the Bazaar section. The evaluation covers parameters such as performance, ease of use, value for money and the build quality/features of the product in question and then arrives at an overall rating.

Here each of these parameters is given a weightage of 25 per cent and is rated on a scale of 5, which is represented by arrows (▶).

The greater the number of arrows, the better the product. This simple five-point rating system is designed to give you an easy-to-interpret assessment of a product. For example, a product that receives an overall score of five arrows signifies an outstanding buy!

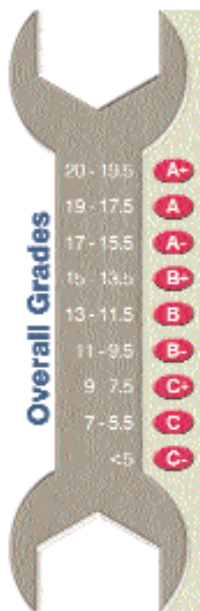
Comparison Tests

We use a dual rating system, the first of which is applied to the Comparison Tests in which we compare the performance of products within a particular category.

Each product is evaluated under different parameters such as performance, value for money, features, warranty and support, etc.

Weightages are then applied to the various test parameters according to their importance for that particular category of products.

These weightages are then used to arrive at an overall grade for each individual product. An overall grade of A+, therefore, indicates that the product is close to perfection.



The 5-point Rating System used in Bazaar

▶▶▶▶▶	Excellent: a brilliant combination of price, performance and features—far beyond expectations
▶▶▶▶▶	Good: a good buy, better than most products in its category
▶▶▶▶▶	Average: reasonably competent but nothing spectacular about the product
▶▶▶▶▶	Mediocre: does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas
▶▶▶▶▶	Poor: has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application

In Test this Month

This month sees the country's first cell phone comparison test with 22 cellular phones compared over three different categories from eight different vendors. With support for bleeding-edge wireless technologies like Bluetooth, HSCSD and GPRS coupled with a range of features like integrated digital audio and FM radio, find out which cell phone packs the best bundle for you in terms of functionality, performance or both.

We also bring you a showdown between the newest and fastest offerings from Intel and AMD—the Intel Pentium 4 at 2.4 GHz goes head to head against the AMD Athlon 2100+. After having gone through a battery of tests ranging from pure processing horsepower to real-world gaming, office productivity and professional rendering applications, find out which one is still standing at the end of this titanic battle.

On the software front, we answer all your questions about Photoshop 7 from Adobe. Check out it's new features and capabilities and find out whether all that added functionality is worth the upgrade. We also review Mandrake 8.2 and give you the lowdown on one of the most user-friendly Linux distributions to date. Discover how you can install, configure and productively use this alternative operating system for a wide set of applications ranging from multimedia authoring to office applications and even running an Internet/Web server.